

IMAT MOCK EXAM 1 — "Baseline"

60 questions · 100 minutes · scoring: +1.5 correct, -0.4 wrong, 0 blank · personal target: 47/90.0 · Mock exam · answer key + worked solutions at the end

Section A - Logical Reasoning & Reading (Q1-9)

1. "Vaccination operates on the principle of immunological memory. Upon first exposure to an antigen, naïve lymphocytes proliferate and differentiate, generating both effector cells that clear the pathogen and long-lived memory cells. A subsequent encounter with the same antigen triggers a faster and stronger response because memory cells respond at lower antigen concentrations and divide more rapidly than naïve cells."

Which of the following is not supported by the passage?

- A) The secondary immune response exceeds the primary one in magnitude.
- B) Effector cells contribute to pathogen clearance.
- C) Naïve lymphocytes proliferate during the primary response.
- D) Memory cells persist after the initial infection has been cleared.
- E) Memory cells require a higher antigen concentration to activate than naïve cells.

2. "Enzymes lower the activation energy of a reaction without altering the free energy difference between substrates and products. Consequently, an enzyme changes the rate at which equilibrium is reached but never the position of equilibrium."

Which statement is a valid inference?

- A) The ratio of products to substrates at equilibrium is unchanged by the enzyme.
- B) Adding an enzyme increases the equilibrium constant.
- C) Enzymes shift the equilibrium toward products.
- D) A reaction that is unfavourable thermodynamically can be made favourable by adding more enzyme.
- E) An enzyme can make an endergonic reaction exergonic.

3. (General knowledge) Which of the following Italian scientists is best known for discovering a method of staining nervous tissue that allowed the visualisation of individual neurons, a contribution that shared the 1906 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine?

- A) Antonio Meucci
- B) Rita Levi-Montalcini
- C) Galileo Galilei
- D) Camillo Golgi
- E) Guglielmo Marconi

4. Five friends — A, B, C, D, E — sit in a row. B sits immediately to the right of A. C is not adjacent to A. D sits at one of the ends. E sits to the left of D. Which of the following must be true?

- A) E is not at an end.
- B) D sits at the far right.
- C) B is to the left of C.
- D) A is at the far left.
- E) C sits between B and E.

5. All patients with disease X have elevated marker M. Some patients with disease Y also have elevated marker M. No patient with disease X has disease Y. From these, which conclusion necessarily follows?

- A) No patient with disease Y has elevated M.
- B) Every patient with elevated M has disease X or Y.
- C) Some patients with disease Y do not have disease X.
- D) Anyone with elevated M has disease X.
- E) Patients with disease X always have disease Y.

6. In a certain code, READING is written as SFB EJ OH. How is MONKEY written?
A) NPO LEZ B) NPO MFZ C) NPO LFY D) NPO LFZ E) NQO LFZ
7. A clock shows 3:15. What is the angle between the hour and minute hands?
A) 0° B) 7.5° C) 15° D) 22.5° E) 30°
8. If the day after tomorrow is Wednesday, what day was it three days before yesterday?
A) Saturday B) Tuesday C) Friday D) Sunday E) Thursday
9. A sequence begins 2, 6, 12, 20, 30, ... What is the next term?
A) 36 B) 40 C) 42 D) 44 E) 50

Section B - Biology (Q10-32)

10. In which cellular compartment does the Krebs (citric acid) cycle take place?
**A) Mitochondrial matrix
B) Rough endoplasmic reticulum
C) Mitochondrial intermembrane space
D) Nucleus
E) Cytosol**
11. How many net ATP molecules are produced by substrate-level phosphorylation during glycolysis per molecule of glucose?
A) 0 B) 1 C) 2 D) 4 E) 6
12. Which molecule serves as the final electron acceptor of the mitochondrial electron transport chain?
A) Water B) Pyruvate C) FAD D) Oxygen E) NAD⁺
13. The ATP synthase enzyme is located in the:
**A) Inner mitochondrial membrane
B) Cytosol
C) Outer mitochondrial membrane
D) Thylakoid stroma
E) Nuclear envelope**
14. During which phase of cellular respiration is the majority of CO₂ released?
**A) Oxidative phosphorylation
B) Pyruvate oxidation and the Krebs cycle
C) Lactic acid fermentation
D) Glycolysis
E) Substrate-level phosphorylation**
15. Which organelle is the primary site of protein synthesis for proteins destined for secretion?
**A) Peroxisome
B) Nucleolus
C) Smooth endoplasmic reticulum
D) Lysosome
E) Rough endoplasmic reticulum**
16. Which of the following is a function of the Golgi apparatus?
**A) Storage of genetic information
B) Detoxification of hydrogen peroxide
C) ATP production via oxidative phosphorylation
D) Synthesis of ribosomal RNA
E) Modification, sorting, and packaging of proteins**

- 17.** Which structure is responsible for the selective permeability of the cell membrane?
- A)** The cytoskeleton
 - B)** The nuclear pore complex alone
 - C)** The cell wall of cellulose
 - D)** The phospholipid bilayer with embedded proteins
 - E)** The peptidoglycan layer
- 18.** Which transport mechanism requires the direct hydrolysis of ATP to move a substance against its concentration gradient?
- A)** Simple diffusion
 - B)** Facilitated diffusion via channels
 - C)** Primary active transport
 - D)** Passive carrier-mediated diffusion
 - E)** Osmosis
- 19.** Which of the following correctly describes the induced-fit model of enzyme action?
- A)** The substrate is permanently altered and the enzyme consumed.
 - B)** The enzyme changes shape upon substrate binding to improve the fit.
 - C)** The enzyme raises ΔG of the reaction.
 - D)** Competitively bound inhibitors bind allosteric sites.
 - E)** The active site is rigid and only one substrate can bind.
- 20.** A competitive inhibitor of an enzyme:
- A)** Increases K_m but does not change V_{max} .
 - B)** Decreases V_{max} but does not change K_m .
 - C)** Binds covalently to the active site, inactivating the enzyme permanently.
 - D)** Cannot be overcome by increasing substrate concentration.
 - E)** Binds reversibly at a site other than the active site.
- 21.** Which type of muscle is involuntary, striated, and has branched cells connected by intercalated discs?
- A)** Myoepithelium
 - B)** Smooth muscle
 - C)** Cardiac muscle
 - D)** Skeletal muscle
 - E)** Tendons
- 22.** The functional unit of contraction in skeletal muscle is the:
- A)** Sarcolemma
 - B)** Sarcoplasm
 - C)** Sarcoplasmic reticulum
 - D)** Myofibril
 - E)** Sarcomere
- 23.** During the sliding filament mechanism, myosin binds to:
- A)** Myosin-binding site on titin
 - B)** Actin
 - C)** Troponin
 - D)** Tropomyosin
 - E)** Calcium directly
- 24.** Oxygen is transported in blood primarily:
- A)** Within leucocytes
 - B)** Bound to albumin
 - C)** Dissolved in plasma
 - D)** Bound to haemoglobin in red blood cells
 - E)** As bicarbonate ions

25. In which part of the human digestive system does the majority of nutrient absorption occur?
A) Small intestine
B) Large intestine
C) Stomach
D) Oesophagus
E) Liver
26. Which hormone, produced by the beta cells of the pancreas, lowers blood glucose concentration?
A) Glucagon **B)** Adrenaline **C)** Thyroxine **D)** Insulin **E)** Cortisol
27. Which hormone is released from the posterior pituitary and causes water reabsorption in the kidney collecting duct?
A) Antidiuretic hormone (ADH / vasopressin)
B) Atrial natriuretic peptide
C) Growth hormone
D) Aldosterone
E) Prolactin
28. Which bone of the upper limb is the humerus? It is the:
A) Thigh bone
B) Upper arm bone
C) Shin bone
D) Forearm bone (thumb side)
E) Collar bone
29. In DNA replication, the enzyme that unwinds the double helix at the replication fork is:
A) Telomerase **B)** Ligase **C)** DNA polymerase **D)** Primase **E)** Helicase
30. In a diploid organism with $2n = 46$, how many chromosomes are present in a mature gamete?
A) 23 **B)** 44 **C)** 46 **D)** 48 **E)** 92
31. A man with blood group AB and a woman with blood group O have a child. Which blood groups are possible in their offspring?
A) A and AB
B) AB only
C) A and B only
D) O only
E) A, B, AB, and O
32. During translation, the codon AUG serves to:
A) Bind release factors
B) Code for tryptophan only
C) Act as the start codon and code for methionine
D) Recruit RNA polymerase
E) Terminate translation

Section C - Chemistry (Q33-47)

33. What is the oxidation number of sulfur in H_2SO_4 ?
A) -2 **B)** 0 **C)** $+2$ **D)** $+4$ **E)** $+6$
34. In the reaction $\text{Zn} + \text{CuSO}_4 \rightarrow \text{ZnSO}_4 + \text{Cu}$, which species is reduced?
A) Zn **B)** Cu^{2+} **C)** Zn^{2+} **D)** Cu (metal) **E)** SO_4^{2-}
35. An acidic aqueous solution at 25°C has a pH of 3. The concentration of H^+ is:
A) $1 \times 10^{-3} \text{ M}$ **B)** $1 \times 10^3 \text{ M}$ **C)** $1 \times 10^{-11} \text{ M}$ **D)** $3 \times 10^{-1} \text{ M}$ **E)** 3 M

36. What is the pH of a 0.01 M solution of a strong monoprotic acid (e.g., HCl) at 25 °C?
A) 1 B) 2 C) 3 D) 12 E) 13
37. Which type of bond involves the complete transfer of electrons from one atom to another?
**A) Metallic bond
B) Van der Waals interaction
C) Hydrogen bond
D) Ionic bond
E) Covalent bond**
38. How many electrons are shared in a double covalent bond between two atoms?
A) 1 B) 2 C) 3 D) 4 E) 6
39. At constant temperature and pressure, the volume of a gas is directly proportional to the number of moles. This is:
A) Boyle's law B) Dalton's law C) Avogadro's law D) Charles's law E) Henry's law
40. Calculate the number of molecules in 0.5 mol of N₂ (Avogadro's number = 6.022×10^{23}).
A) 1.20×10^{24} B) 1.50×10^{23} C) 3.01×10^{23} D) 6.02×10^{23} E) 6.02×10^{22}
41. Which element is in Group 17 and Period 3 of the periodic table?
A) Fluorine B) Iodine C) Sulfur D) Bromine E) Chlorine
42. Which subatomic particle has no electric charge and a mass of approximately 1 amu?
A) Neutron B) Proton C) Photon D) Positron E) Electron
43. For the equilibrium $\text{N}_2(\text{g}) + 3\text{H}_2(\text{g}) \rightleftharpoons 2\text{NH}_3(\text{g})$, $\Delta H < 0$. Increasing the pressure at constant temperature will:
**A) Shift the equilibrium to the left, producing more N₂ and H₂.
B) Shift equilibrium to the right, producing more NH₃
C) Decrease the rate only
D) Increase the temperature
E) Have no effect**
44. The functional group -COOH characterises which class of organic compounds?
**A) Alcohols
B) Ethers
C) Aldehydes
D) Carboxylic acids
E) Ketones**
45. Which of the following compounds is an alkane?
A) C₂H₄ B) C₂H₂ C) C₆H₆ D) C₃H₆ E) C₄H₁₀
46. The rate of a chemical reaction generally increases with temperature because:
**A) The activation energy decreases.
B) The reaction becomes exothermic.
C) The equilibrium constant always increases.
D) Catalysts form spontaneously.
E) More collisions occur with energy $\geq E_a$ per unit time.**
47. What is the molar concentration of a solution containing 0.2 mol of NaCl dissolved to make 500 mL of solution?
A) 0.1 M B) 0.2 M C) 0.4 M D) 0.5 M E) 1.0 M

Section D - Mathematics (Q48-54)

48. Solve for x : $\sqrt{2x - 1} = 3$.

- A) $x = 2$ B) $x = 3$ C) $x = 6$ D) $x = 5$ E) $x = 4$

49. Solve: $2x - 5 < 3x + 1$.

- A) $x > -6$ B) $x < 6$ C) $x < -6$ D) $x = -6$ E) $x > 6$

50. In a triangle, two angles are 50° and 60° . What is the third angle?

- A) 50° B) 60° C) 70° D) 80° E) 90°

51. If $f(x) = 2x^2 - 3x + 1$, what is $f(2)$?

- A) 1 B) 2 C) 3 D) 5 E) 7

52. A circle has radius 5 cm. What is its area? (Take $\pi = 3.14$.)

- A) 15.7 cm^2 B) 25 cm^2 C) 31.4 cm^2 D) 62.8 cm^2 E) 78.5 cm^2

53. A bag contains 3 red and 2 blue balls. One ball is drawn at random. What is the probability it is blue?

- A) $1/5$ B) $1/2$ C) $2/5$ D) $2/3$ E) $3/5$

54. A rectangle has length 12 cm and diagonal 13 cm. What is its perimeter?

- A) 24 cm B) 28 cm C) 30 cm D) 34 cm E) 36 cm

Section E - Physics (Q55-60)

55. A car travels 120 km in 2 hours at constant velocity. What is its speed in m/s?

- A) 16.7 m/s B) 33.3 m/s C) 50 m/s D) 60 m/s E) 120 m/s

56. Three resistors of 2Ω , 3Ω , and 6Ω are connected in parallel. What is the equivalent resistance?

- A) 0.5Ω B) 1Ω C) 3.66Ω D) 6Ω E) 11Ω

57. A current of 2 A flows through a 5Ω resistor. What is the power dissipated?

- A) 5 W B) 10 W C) 20 W D) 50 W E) 100 W

58. A book rests on a table. The reaction force of the table on the book is an example of which law?

- A) Hooke's law
B) Newton's third law
C) Newton's second law only
D) Newton's first law only
E) Ohm's law

59. The gravitational force between two bodies is $F = Gm_1m_2/r^2$. If the distance between the two bodies is halved, the gravitational force becomes:

- A) $2F$ B) F C) $F/2$ D) $4F$ E) $F/4$

60. The pressure at depth h in a fluid of density ρ is given by $P = \rho gh$. If $\rho = 1000 \text{ kg/m}^3$, $g = 9.8 \text{ m/s}^2$, and $h = 10 \text{ m}$, what is the gauge pressure?

- A) 9,800 Pa B) 98 Pa C) 98,000 Pa D) 980 Pa E) 980,000 Pa

Answer key

This key refers to the option order printed in this paper. The online app shuffles option order on every attempt, so answer letters inside the app will differ from the ones here.

1	E	2	A	3	D	4	B	5	C
6	D	7	B	8	E	9	C	10	A
11	C	12	D	13	A	14	B	15	E
16	E	17	D	18	C	19	B	20	A
21	C	22	E	23	B	24	D	25	A
26	D	27	A	28	B	29	E	30	A
31	C	32	C	33	E	34	B	35	A
36	B	37	D	38	D	39	C	40	C
41	E	42	A	43	B	44	D	45	E
46	E	47	C	48	D	49	A	50	C
51	C	52	E	53	C	54	D	55	A
56	B	57	C	58	B	59	D	60	C

Worked solutions

Each solution shows the reasoning that produces the key, and names the wrong options by their content. Letters refer to the option order printed in this paper.

Question 1 • Answer: E

The passage states that memory cells respond at LOWER antigen concentrations than naive cells, so the claim that they require a higher concentration to activate says the opposite of the text and is not supported. The other four statements all follow from the passage: long-lived memory cells persist after the pathogen is cleared, the secondary response is faster and stronger (so larger in magnitude), naive lymphocytes proliferate on first exposure, and effector cells clear the pathogen. The tempting trap is the magnitude claim, because it looks like an added detail, yet the passage's 'faster and stronger response' explicitly backs it.

Question 2 • Answer: A

An enzyme lowers the activation energy but leaves the free energy difference between substrates and products unchanged, so the equilibrium position, and therefore the products-to-substrates ratio at equilibrium, is exactly the same with or without enzyme. Every claim that the enzyme makes an endergonic reaction exergonic, raises the equilibrium constant, shifts equilibrium toward products, or turns an unfavourable reaction favourable would require changing the free energy difference, which the passage rules out. More enzyme only means equilibrium is reached sooner, never a different equilibrium.

Question 3 • Answer: D

Camillo Golgi developed the silver-based 'black reaction' for staining nervous tissue, which first allowed individual whole neurons to be seen under the microscope, and he shared the 1906 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine with Ramon y Cajal. The decisive facts are the staining method plus the 1906 prize. The other names belong to different fields: Galileo (astronomy and physics), Levi-Montalcini (nerve growth factor, 1986 Nobel), Meucci (early telephone work), Marconi (radio, 1909 Nobel in Physics).

Question 4 • Answer: B

Step 1: D must sit at one of the two ends. Step 2: E must sit somewhere to D's left, so D cannot take the left end, because then no seat would exist to the left of D for E. Therefore D is forced to the far right. Every other claim can fail in a valid arrangement: the A-B pair could start at seat 2 (leaving the far left free), E can occupy the far left end, and C only has to avoid sitting next to A, so none of those statements must be true.

Question 5 • Answer: C

Some patients with disease Y have elevated marker M, and no patient with disease X has disease Y, so those M-positive Y patients cannot belong to X: hence some Y patients do not have X. The other conclusions all fail: people outside X and Y could also show elevated M (so elevated M does not imply X or Y), Y patients can clearly have elevated M, and nothing suggests X leads to Y. The valid core is a syllogism: some Y have M, X and Y are disjoint, therefore some Y are not X.

Question 6 • Answer: D

Each letter of READING is shifted one place forward in the alphabet (R to S, E to F, A to B, D to E, I to J, N to O), keeping the split after three and six letters. Applying the same shift to MONKEY gives N, P, O, L, F, Z, that is NPO LFZ. A near miss such as NPO MFZ fails because K shifted one place forward is L, not M, so check every position rather than just the first few letters.

Question 7 • Answer: B

The minute hand moves 6 degrees per minute, so at 15 minutes it sits at 90 degrees. The hour hand moves 0.5 degrees per minute: at 3:00 it is at 90 degrees and by 3:15 it has advanced $15 \times 0.5 = 7.5$ degrees, to 97.5 degrees. The angle between the hands is $97.5 - 90 = 7.5$ degrees. The tempting error is answering 0 degrees by assuming the hands overlap at 3:15; they actually overlap only shortly after, at about 3:16.

Question 8 • Answer: E

If the day after tomorrow is Wednesday, today is Monday. Yesterday was therefore Sunday, and counting back three days from Sunday gives Saturday, Friday, Thursday, so the answer is Thursday. Sanity check forward: Thursday plus 3 days is Sunday (yesterday), plus one more day is Monday (today), plus two more is Wednesday (day after tomorrow).

Question 9 • Answer: C

The gaps between successive terms are 4, 6, 8 and 10, each 2 larger than the previous, so the next gap is 12 and the next term is $30 + 12 = 42$. Equivalently, the terms follow $n(n+1)$: $1 \times 2 = 2$, $2 \times 3 = 6$, $3 \times 4 = 12$, $4 \times 5 = 20$, $5 \times 6 = 30$, so the sixth term is $6 \times 7 = 42$.

Question 10 • Answer: A

The Krebs cycle runs in the mitochondrial matrix, where pyruvate is imported, decarboxylated to acetyl-CoA by pyruvate dehydrogenase, and progressively oxidised. Glycolysis is the cytosol stage, and the intermembrane space is where protons accumulate for chemiosmosis, not where the cycle turns.

Question 11 • Answer: C

Glycolysis spends 2 ATP in the investment phase (hexokinase and phosphofructokinase) and makes 4 ATP in the payoff phase (phosphoglycerate kinase and pyruvate kinase), both by substrate-level phosphorylation, giving a net of $4 - 2 = 2$ ATP per glucose. The trap is quoting the gross yield of 4 and forgetting the 2 invested during the early steps.

Question 12 • Answer: D

Oxygen is the terminal electron acceptor: at complex IV it accepts electrons and is reduced to water, and without it the whole chain backs up and oxidative phosphorylation halts. Water is the product of that reduction, not the acceptor, and NAD^+ and FAD are upstream carriers that deliver electrons into the chain rather than final acceptors.

Question 13 • Answer: A

ATP synthase (complex V) sits in the inner mitochondrial membrane, folded into cristae, and uses the proton gradient between intermembrane space and matrix to drive ADP phosphorylation. The outer membrane and cytosol are not involved, and the thylakoid reference confuses chloroplast anatomy: the chloroplast ATP synthase spans the thylakoid membrane, not a stroma.

Question 14 • Answer: B

Glycolysis and oxidative phosphorylation release no CO_2 at all. Pyruvate oxidation releases one CO_2 per pyruvate and each turn of the Krebs cycle releases two, so all six CO_2 molecules per glucose come from pyruvate oxidation together with the Krebs cycle, making that pair the sole source.

Question 15 • Answer: E

Secretory proteins are synthesised by ribosomes docked on the rough ER, whose studding by ribosomes gives it its name, and they then travel to the Golgi for processing. The smooth ER handles lipids and detoxification, and the nucleolus builds ribosomal subunits, not secreted proteins.

Question 16 • Answer: E

The Golgi receives vesicles from the ER, chemically modifies its cargo (for example by glycosylation), sorts it, and packages it into vesicles for dispatch. The other listed jobs belong elsewhere: ribosomal RNA is made in the nucleolus, oxidative phosphorylation occurs in mitochondria, hydrogen peroxide breakdown is catalase in peroxisomes, and genetic information is stored in the nucleus.

Question 17 • Answer: D

Selective permeability is a property of the phospholipid bilayer itself, whose hydrophobic core blocks ions and large polar molecules, while embedded channel and carrier proteins admit specific solutes. Cell walls such as peptidoglycan or cellulose are porous structural layers rather than selective barriers, and the cytoskeleton provides shape and transport tracks, not permeability.

Question 18 • Answer: C

Primary active transport couples movement against the gradient directly to ATP hydrolysis, as in the sodium-potassium pump. Simple diffusion, osmosis, and channel- or carrier-mediated facilitated diffusion are all passive and run downhill on the gradient, so they consume no ATP at all.

Question 19 • Answer: B

In the induced-fit model the active site is flexible and changes conformation when the substrate binds, moulding around it to align the catalytic groups. The rigid-site picture is the older lock-and-key model, and nothing in induced fit changes the free energy of the reaction or consumes the enzyme.

Question 20 • Answer: A

A competitive inhibitor binds reversibly at the active site and competes with the substrate, so more substrate is needed to reach half-maximal rate: the apparent K_m increases while V_{max} stays the same, because saturating substrate outcompetes the inhibitor. The pattern of a lowered V_{max} with unchanged K_m belongs to non-competitive inhibition instead, and no covalent permanent inactivation is involved.

Question 21 • Answer: C

Cardiac muscle is involuntary, striated and built of branched cells joined end to end by intercalated discs, whose gap junctions synchronise contraction. Skeletal muscle is striated but voluntary with unbranched fibres, and smooth muscle is involuntary but not striated, so only cardiac tissue satisfies all three descriptors at once.

Question 22 • Answer: E

The sarcomere, the segment from one Z-disc to the next, is the smallest unit that shortens, so it is the functional unit of skeletal muscle. A myofibril is the whole chain of sarcomeres inside a fibre, the sarcolemma is the cell membrane, and the sarcoplasmic reticulum is the calcium store.

Question 23 • Answer: B

During contraction, calcium binds troponin, tropomyosin shifts away from the binding sites, and the myosin heads attach to actin to form cross-bridges that pull. Calcium regulates the process through troponin and does not bind myosin directly, and titin is the elastic scaffold rather than the myosin partner.

Question 24 • Answer: D

About 98 percent of oxygen travels bound to haemoglobin inside red blood cells, with only a small remainder dissolved in plasma. Bicarbonate is the main transport form of carbon dioxide, not oxygen, and albumin or leucocytes play no role in oxygen carriage.

Question 25 • Answer: A

Most nutrient absorption occurs in the small intestine, whose villi and microvilli create an enormous surface area and whose length gives long contact time, with the jejunum the busiest stretch. The stomach mainly digests, the large intestine mostly reclaims water and ions, and the oesophagus and liver absorb essentially nothing.

Question 26 • Answer: D

Beta cells of the pancreatic islets secrete insulin, which promotes glucose uptake into cells and storage as glycogen, lowering blood glucose. Glucagon, released by alpha cells, does the opposite and raises glucose, while cortisol, adrenaline and thyroxine also tend to raise blood glucose rather than lower it.

Question 27 • Answer: A

Antidiuretic hormone (ADH, vasopressin) is released from the posterior pituitary and causes the collecting duct to insert aquaporin channels, so water is reabsorbed and urine is concentrated. Aldosterone instead promotes sodium reabsorption from the adrenal cortex, and atrial natriuretic peptide promotes sodium loss, the reverse of ADH.

Question 28 • Answer: B

The humerus is the single long bone of the upper arm, running from shoulder to elbow. The femur is the thigh bone, the radius is the thumb-side forearm bone, the tibia is the shin bone, and the clavicle is the collar bone, so only the upper-arm description matches.

Question 29 • Answer: E

Helicase unwinds the double helix by breaking the hydrogen bonds between base pairs at the replication fork. DNA polymerase then builds the new strands, primase lays the RNA primers, and ligase seals the nicks between Okazaki fragments, so the unwinding job belongs to helicase alone.

Question 30 • Answer: A

A diploid count of $2n = 46$ means body cells carry 46 chromosomes; meiosis halves this, so a mature gamete carries the haploid number $n = 23$. Fertilisation then restores 46 in the zygote.

Question 31 • Answer: C

The AB father contributes either the A or the B allele, while the O mother can pass only the recessive allele i. Every child is therefore Ai (group A) or Bi (group B): AB is impossible because the mother supplies no A or B allele, and O is impossible because the father always supplies A or B. So only groups A and B can appear among the offspring.

Question 32 • Answer: C

AUG is the start codon: it sets the reading frame and codes for methionine (N-formylmethionine in bacteria). Termination is handled by the stop codons UAA, UAG and UGA together with release factors, and RNA polymerase is recruited to DNA promoters, never by codons.

Question 33 • Answer: E

Oxidation numbers sum to zero in a neutral molecule: $2(+1)$ for hydrogen plus x for sulfur plus $4(-2)$ for oxygen gives $2 + x - 8 = 0$, so $x = +6$. The +2 distractor follows from wrongly taking each oxygen as -1 instead of -2 , and +4 comes from miscounting the total oxygen contribution.

Question 34 • Answer: B

In $\text{Zn} + \text{CuSO}_4 \rightarrow \text{ZnSO}_4 + \text{Cu}$ the copper ion gains two electrons ($\text{Cu}^{2+} + 2\text{e}^- \rightarrow \text{Cu}$), so Cu^{2+} is reduced, while zinc loses electrons to become Zn^{2+} and is oxidised. The sulfate ion is a spectator throughout, and metallic copper is the reduced product rather than the species being reduced.

Question 35 • Answer: A

pH is defined as $-\log[\text{H}^+]$, so pH 3 means $[\text{H}^+] = 10^{-3} = 1 \times 10^{-3} \text{ M}$. The $1 \times 10^{-11} \text{ M}$ figure is the hydroxide concentration ($\text{pOH} = 14 - 3 = 11$), a classic mix-up, and no option with a factor of 3 belongs in the conversion since pH is a logarithmic scale.

Question 36 • Answer: B

A strong monoprotic acid dissociates completely, so 0.01 M HCl gives $[\text{H}^+] = 0.01 = 10^{-2} \text{ M}$ and $\text{pH} = -\log(10^{-2}) = 2$. The values 12 and 13 come from computing pOH-style numbers as if the solution were basic rather than acidic.

Question 37 • Answer: D

An ionic bond forms by complete transfer of electrons from one atom to another, producing oppositely charged ions held together by electrostatic attraction, as when sodium donates an electron to chlorine. Covalent bonds share electrons, hydrogen bonds and van der Waals interactions are weak intermolecular attractions, and metallic bonding uses a delocalised electron sea.

Question 38 • Answer: D

A double covalent bond consists of two shared electron pairs, that is $2 \times 2 = 4$ electrons, as in the $\text{O}=\text{O}$ bond or the $\text{C}=\text{O}$ bonds of CO_2 . Counting one pair gives 2, which describes a single bond, not a double one.

Question 39 • Answer: C

Volume proportional to the number of moles at constant temperature and pressure is Avogadro's law ($V \propto n$). Boyle's law covers $V \propto 1/P$ at fixed n and T , and Charles's law covers $V \propto T$ at fixed n and P , so the mole-proportionality is the distinctive signature of Avogadro's law.

Question 40 • Answer: C

Number of molecules = moles $\times$ Avogadro's number = $0.5 \times 6.022 \times 10^{23} = 3.011 \times 10^{23}$, so approximately 3.01×10^{23} molecules. The 6.02×10^{23} answer forgets to halve the mole quantity, and 6.02×10^{22} is a factor-of-10 slip.

Question 41 • Answer: E

Period 3 runs Na, Mg, Al, Si, P, S, Cl, Ar, and the Group 17 halogens fall F (period 2), Cl (period 3), Br (period 4), I (period 5). The intersection is chlorine. Fluorine has the right group but sits in period 2, and sulfur is period 3 but Group 16.

Question 42 • Answer: A

The neutron carries no electric charge and has a mass of about 1 amu, essentially equal to the proton. The proton is positively charged, the electron is negative and roughly $1/1836$ of an amu, and a photon is a massless quantum of electromagnetic radiation.

Question 43 • Answer: B

By Le Chatelier's principle, raising the pressure at constant temperature shifts the equilibrium toward the side with fewer gas moles. The left side has 4 moles ($1 \text{ N}_2 + 3 \text{ H}_2$) and the right side has 2 (2 NH_3), so the balance moves right and more ammonia forms. Note the reaction's exothermicity is irrelevant here: pressure, not temperature, is what changes.

Question 44 • Answer: D

The COOH (carboxyl) group is the signature of carboxylic acids. Alcohols carry OH, aldehydes carry CHO, ketones have an internal C=O, and ethers have a C-O-C linkage, so the acidic carboxyl description decides the question.

Question 45 • Answer: E

Alkanes follow the formula $\text{C}_n\text{H}_{2n+2}$: for $n = 4$ this predicts C_4H_{10} (butane), which matches exactly. C_2H_4 and C_3H_6 fit C_nH_{2n} (alkenes or cycloalkanes), C_2H_2 fits $\text{C}_n\text{H}_{2n-2}$ (alkyne), and C_6H_6 is aromatic benzene, so none of those is a saturated alkane.

Question 46 • Answer: E

Raising the temperature increases the fraction of colliding molecules whose energy meets or exceeds the activation energy (the Arrhenius picture, $k = A \cdot e^{(-E_a/RT)}$) and also raises collision frequency, so the rate rises. The activation energy itself is fixed by the reaction pathway and does not decrease with heating, and the equilibrium constant grows with temperature only for endothermic reactions, so it does not always increase.

Question 47 • Answer: C

Molarity = moles of solute $\div$ litres of solution = $0.2 \text{ mol} \div 0.500 \text{ L} = 0.4 \text{ M}$. The 0.2 M figure skips the division by the 0.5 L volume, so convert millilitres to litres before dividing.

Question 48 • Answer: D

Step 1: square both sides: $2x - 1 = 9$. Step 2: solve: $2x = 10$, so $x = 5$. Check: $\sqrt{(2 \times 5 - 1)} = \sqrt{9} = 3$, and the domain condition $2x - 1 \geq 0$ is satisfied. Any smaller listed value leaves the expression under the root unequal to 9.

Question 49 • Answer: A

Rearrange: $2x - 5 < 3x + 1$ gives $-5 - 1 < 3x - 2x$, so $-6 < x$, that is $x > -6$. No sign flip is needed because nothing is divided by a negative number; the answer $x < -6$ incorrectly reverses the inequality.

Question 50 • Answer: C

Angles in a triangle sum to 180 degrees, so the third angle is $180 - 50 - 60 = 70$ degrees.

Question 51 • Answer: C

Substitute $x = 2$: $f(2) = 2(2^2) - 3(2) + 1 = 8 - 6 + 1 = 3$.

Question 52 • Answer: E

Area of a circle $= \pi r^2 = 3.14 \times 5^2 = 3.14 \times 25 = 78.5 \text{ cm}^2$. The 31.4 figure is actually the circumference ($2\pi r = 2 \times 3.14 \times 5$) wearing area units, and 62.8 is simply double that, so both come from mixing up the circle formulas.

Question 53 • Answer: C

There are $3 + 2 = 5$ balls in total and 2 of them are blue, so $P(\text{blue}) = 2/5$. The $3/5$ figure is the probability of the complementary event, drawing a red ball.

Question 54 • Answer: D

Step 1: the diagonal, length and width form a right triangle: $13^2 = 12^2 + w^2$, so $w^2 = 169 - 144 = 25$ and $w = 5 \text{ cm}$ (the 5-12-13 Pythagorean triple). Step 2: perimeter $= 2 \times (12 + 5) = 34 \text{ cm}$. The 24 cm figure comes from doubling only the length and forgetting the width entirely.

Question 55 • Answer: A

Speed $= 120 \text{ km} \div 2 \text{ h} = 60 \text{ km/h}$; converting with $1 \text{ km/h} = 1000 \text{ m} \div 3600 \text{ s}$ gives $60 \times 1000/3600 \approx 16.7 \text{ m/s}$. The 33.3 m/s figure results from dividing 120 000 m by only 3600 s, forgetting that the trip lasted two hours, and 60 m/s mistakes the km/h number for a value in m/s.

Question 56 • Answer: B

Step 1: for parallel resistors, $1/R = 1/2 + 1/3 + 1/6$. Step 2: with common denominator 6: $(3 + 2 + 1)/6 = 6/6 = 1$, so $R = 1 \Omega$. Adding the resistances to get 11Ω is the series rule and does not apply; a parallel equivalent is always smaller than the smallest individual resistor.

Question 57 • Answer: C

Power dissipated by a resistor is $P = I^2 R = 2^2 \times 5 = 4 \times 5 = 20 \text{ W}$. The 10 W figure is just the voltage drop ($IR = 2 \times 5 = 10 \text{ V}$), which is a voltage in volts, not a power in watts.

Question 58 • Answer: B

The upward push of the table on the book and the downward push of the book on the table form an action-reaction pair on two different bodies, which is Newton's third law. The first law only explains why the book stays at rest under zero net force; it does not pair the two forces together.

Question 59 • Answer: D

Gravitational force scales as the inverse square of the distance: with r replaced by $r/2$, $F' = Gm_1 m_2 / (r/2)^2 = 4 \times Gm_1 m_2 / r^2 = 4F$. The $2F$ answer comes from inverting the distance once instead of squaring the inversion.

Question 60 • Answer: C

Gauge pressure $P = \rho gh = 1000 \text{ kg/m}^3 \times 9.8 \text{ m/s}^2 \times 10 \text{ m} = 98\,000 \text{ Pa}$. Gauge pressure excludes atmospheric pressure, so nothing is added on top. The 980 Pa figure is two orders of magnitude low and 980 000 Pa is a factor-of-10 overshoot, both unit-handling slips.